
Hackles Day in a Box

The Hackles Kit

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A budget sheet and a short outline for running Hackles Day, the school event in the kit. The full plan is in `kit/07_Assessment/Hackles_Day_Kit.md`, with an add-on in `kit/14_Games_and_Fun/09_Hackles_Day_Event_Plan.md`. This page adds the money and the logistics that an administrator asks about. The workbook is `Hackles_Day_Budget.xlsx`.

What Hackles Day is

A **SCHOOL OR LIBRARY** event where students move through short stations that practice Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell and the Help Ladder, followed by an optional family night. It is not a presentation by outsiders about scary stories. Station leaders are staff, trained volunteers, and older students. Volunteers never work alone with students, follow your visitor and background-check policy, and are not agents of the publisher. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] The kit says to keep sponsor branding out and never to collect student information.

Formats (pick one)

FORMAT	TIME	NEEDS	BEST FOR
Classroom mini Hackles Day	45 minutes	One teacher, no volunteers	Smallest budget
Single-band event	90 minutes	Stations for one band, staff only	One grade band
Half-day rotation	3 to 4 hours	Stations by band, volunteers, counselor corner	Whole school
Family night	60 to 75 minutes (evening)	Presenter, counselor, handouts	Families

What goes in the box

ITEM	SOURCE IN THE KIT	NOTES
Station cards and activity sheets by band	Hackles Day Kit, section 4	Station counts vary by band and school; the budget sheet uses 8 as a placeholder
Puzzle hunts with answer keys	Hackles Day Kit, section 5	Print the answer keys only for station leaders
Passport (one per student)	Hackles Day Kit, section 12	Folded paper with a stamp space per station and a My Trusted Adults page
Certificates	Hackles Day Kit, section 9	
Volunteer rules and training agenda	Hackles Day Kit, section 7	60-minute training
Family night agenda and script	Hackles Day Kit, section 8; Parent Night Presentation Script	
Counselor Corner, Tell Someone Wall, quiet space	Hackles Day Kit, signage section	
Counselor coordination	Counselor Coordination Protocol (this pack)	Sensitive activities need heads-up and notice
First 10 Minutes card	Crisis and Disclosure Flowchart	One for every station leader and volunteer
Photo and media rules	Hackles Day Kit, safety section	Default: no photos of students in promotion

The budget sheet

THE WORKBOOK HAS TWO sheets. On **Inputs** you type the number of students, family members, volunteers, stations, interpreter hours and childcare hours. On **Budget** each line multiplies a quantity by a unit cost. Two unit-cost columns, standard and low-cost, give you a range. A column for donated or in-kind value shows the net cost. A bar chart compares the two scenarios. Contingency defaults to 10%.

The unit costs in the workbook are placeholders. They are rough starting numbers, not quotes and not facts about your area. Replace each with a quote from your vendor or your copy center before you present the budget. [VERIFY]

EXAMPLE RUN (300 STUDENTS, 150 FAMILY MEMBERS, 12 VOLUNTEERS, 8 STATIONS)

SCENARIO	SUBTOTAL	WITH 10% CONTINGENCY	PER STUDENT
Standard placeholder costs	\$1,350.00	\$1,485.00	\$4.95
Low-cost placeholder costs	\$186.00	\$204.60	\$0.68

The low-cost column assumes classroom supplies, school-owned lanyards, bilingual staff in place of paid interpreters, volunteer childcare under your supervision policy, and no food. It is a planning scenario, not a recommendation to skip interpreters where families need them.

BUDGET LINES

LINE	BASIS	WHAT TO CHECK
Printing: student passports	4 pages per student	Use your copy center price
Printing: family handouts	6 pages per family	
Printing: station cards, signs, hunt sheets	25 pages per station	
Certificates	1 per student	Cardstock or plain paper
Craft and station supplies	per 100 students	Classroom stock first
Stamps, stickers, ribbons	per student	No sponsor branding; no sign-up rewards
Volunteer badges and lanyards	per volunteer	Reuse
Food and drink	per family	Optional; check allergy and food policies
Translation and interpreters	hours	Qualified interpreters; do not rely on machine translation for safety wording
Childcare during family night	staff-hours	Only if offered; follow supervision policy
Posters and signage	lump sum	
First aid, tissues, sanitizer	lump sum	
Thank-you items	per volunteer	Check your gift policy

Funding and sponsors

- Pay from an existing operating or PTA line if possible.
- Do not accept sponsorship that puts a brand on lessons, advertises to children, or collects student data. [VERIFY district sponsorship policy]
- If a local business offers to donate, accept goods that carry no promotion to students, such as paper or snacks, and thank them privately.
- Competence Collective has not agreed to fund events or send staff. [CONTACT: to be added]

Timeline (8 weeks)

WHEN	TASK
8 to 6 weeks before	Pick the date and format. Set the budget. Book space, volunteers and the counselor
5 to 3 weeks before	Complete volunteer vetting per your policy. Print passports and station cards. Recruit older-student helpers
2 weeks before	Family letters. Sensitive stations flagged with pre-notice and alternates
1 week before	Volunteer training (60 minutes). Final counts. Dry run
Day before	Set up stations and signs. Confirm counselor coverage
Event day	Check-in. First 10 Minutes cards out. Counselor Corner open
After	Thank-yous. Counts to the tracker. Debrief

Safety rules at the event

1. Counselor or backup on site the whole time.
2. Volunteers never alone with a student, never take photos of students on personal devices, and hand out nothing from a company.
3. Station leaders carry the First 10 Minutes card and know the local reporting route.
4. Any station that covers a sensitive topic is not run as a public performance, and nobody is asked to share personal experiences.
5. Plan for accessibility: wheelchair routes, sensory-friendly space, large print, interpreters, quiet room.
6. Count attendance by number. Do not collect names for the tracker.

After the event

ADD COUNTS TO THE tracker's Family sheet (attendees) and note any follow-up in your confidential files. Share a short thank-you with families. Use the evidence-limits wording if you report any survey results.